

don't have the time or means to take care of their elders. You cannot count on your kids as a security blanket for your own future. The sooner you can get that idea through your head, the better off you'll be.

Frankly, unless you're rolling in cash, I endorse having only two kids. I'm biased, of course, since I've got two great kids myself. Having more than two children becomes a financial risk with a good chance of failure. Your children will carry on your financial legacy, for better or for worse, so why not give them the best chance possible at success?

Money Mistake: *You've Bought into Traditional Wisdom About Who Works and Who Stays Home*

The Fix: *Follow the Dollar Signs*

I want to comment briefly on the traditional roles of "breadwinner" and "stay-at-home parent," since we're talking about tying the number of kids you have to your income. For years, it was the father who often went out and earned a living while the mother stayed home to raise the kids. Women were relegated to the domestic realm while men worked their way up the corporate ladder, earning promotions and bigger paychecks. To this day, studies show that a woman in the workplace earns an average of 77 cents to a man's dollar.